Business Intelligence Overview Report: Global Superstore

AnalystLab Africa Data Analytics Internship, Week 2 | Prepared by: Georgewill Stephanie Alaye

1. What Is Business Intelligence?

Business Intelligence (BI) is the process of collecting, cleaning, analysing and presenting business data so that people can understand what is happening in an organisation and act on it. BI combines data preparation, reporting and visualisation tools to turn raw records, such as individual sales transactions, into clear measures like total sales, profit margin and regional performance.

In this project, BI was done with Microsoft Power BI. The Global Superstore dataset was imported, reviewed and cleaned with Power Query, and then modelled into an interactive dashboard that management can explore without needing to read the raw data.

2. Why Organisations Use Dashboards

A dashboard brings the most important measures of a business together on one screen. Organisations use dashboards because they:

- **Save time.** Leaders see key figures at a glance instead of reading long reports or spreadsheets.
- **Track performance continuously.** Key performance indicators (KPIs) such as sales, profit and orders show whether the business is on target.
- **Reveal patterns.** Charts make trends, seasonality and outliers easier to spot than tables of numbers.
- **Support one version of the truth.** Everyone works from the same data and definitions, which reduces disagreement.
- **Allow self-service exploration.** Slicers and filters let managers look at a particular year, region or customer segment themselves.

3. How Dashboards Improve Decision-Making

Dashboards move decisions from guesswork to evidence. They help decision-makers to:

- **Find problems early.** A low margin in one region is visible straight away, so action can be taken before losses grow.
- **Compare options.** Regions, product categories, customer segments and shipping modes can be compared side by side.
- **Prioritise resources.** Management can direct budget, stock and marketing to the areas with the best returns.
- **Plan ahead.** Trend charts show seasonal peaks and dips, which supports planning for stock, staffing and promotions.
- **Communicate clearly.** Visuals and a short insights page make findings easy to share with people who are not analysts.

4. Business Objective of the Selected Dataset

The selected dataset is the **Global Superstore** dataset (Option 2 in the assignment). It contains order-level records for a global retail company, including order dates, ship modes, customer segments, regions and countries, product categories and products, and the sales, profit and quantity of each order.

The business objective is to give senior management an executive dashboard that monitors **sales performance, profitability, customer behaviour and regional performance**, and that turns this data into recommendations for improving the business. The dashboard is designed to answer seven business questions:

1. What is the overall sales performance of the company?
2. Which regions generate the highest sales and profit?
3. Which customer segments contribute the most revenue?
4. Which product categories perform best?
5. Which products are the most profitable?
6. What trends can be observed over time?
7. What recommendations should management implement to improve business performance?

5. How the Dashboard Supports This Objective

The dashboard has five KPI cards (Total Sales, Total Profit, Total Orders, Average Sales and Profit Margin) and visuals for sales by ship mode, the sales and profit trend over time, customer segment revenue, product category performance, top 10 products by profit, sales by region and a regional performance matrix. Slicers for Year, Region and Segment make the analysis interactive. A separate Executive Summary page lists the key insights, risks, opportunities and recommendations, and a profit margin trend by month.

Together, these views allow management to see where the business earns its profit, where margins are weak, and where to focus next, which is the purpose of Business Intelligence.